

Enzo Ferrari's haughty response was, "The problem is not with the car, but the driver!" He went on to advise Lamborghini to go back to taking care of his tractors (*gasp*). For Ferruccio, this was not only an insult but also an open challenge, and it was the reason the world now has Lamborghini super cars, heralded by the Lamborghini 350 GT in 1964.

PET ROCKS

Gary Dahl was a 38-year-old advertising executive from California when he invented the pet rock. He went out drinking with his buddies one day in the April of 1975. The conversation turned to conventional pets and how they required so much of an owner's time and energy. They conjectured how conversely awesome it would be to own a pet rock – they're easy to maintain, cheap and had a great personality.

Dahl spent the next two weeks writing the 'Pet Rock Training Manual' with step-by-step instructions on how to have a happy relationship with your geological pet. He included an actual rock (A beach stone from Rosarita, Mexico) in the gift box shaped pet carrying case,



Man's more convenient best friend

complete with air holes for breathing. A million rocks sold for \$3.95 (~₹250) a piece in a few months and Dahl became a millionaire.

"Place it on some old newspapers. The rock will never know what the paper is for and will require no further instruction."

"I can think of several heuristics for generating ideas for startups, but most reduce to this: look at something people are trying to do, and figure out how to do it in a way that doesn't suck."

– PAUL GRAHAM

FACEBOOK

'The Social Network' is a commendable drama film, but how does it hold up to reality? The basic plot line is fairly accurate, but Mark Zuckerberg himself said that the movie "made up stuff that was hurtful".

Mark, a keen computer programmer, at the age of 23, had already created websites like Course Match and Facemash. The former allowed users to view others taking their courses, while the latter allowed ranking of people based on their "hotness". In February 2004, Zuckerberg created a website called 'The Facebook'. The name was taken from the sheets of paper detailing the profiles of students and staff that was handed out during his freshman year. Within 24 hours, 1,200 Harvard students had signed in and after a month it was half the undergrad population. In September 2006, the reach of the website had extended to anyone with a registered email address. Till date, the site remains free to join, with the welcome page declaring: "It's free and always will be". Although the birth of the site was marred by legal cases by various individuals claiming ownership, both Yahoo! and Google expressed interest in a buy-out. Zuckerberg has decided that he will not, in fact, be selling.

KHAN ACADEMY

Salman Khan (not the actor) has proved that his crazy mission for free, world class education for anyone, anywhere is well on its way to becoming a reality. However, this isn't what he had in mind when he initially started out. In late 2004, Khan began tutoring his cousin Nadia in 7th grade mathematics using Yahoo!'s Doodle notepad. When other relatives and friends sought similar help, he decided it would be more practical to distribute the tutorials on YouTube. The exponentially increasing popularity and the testimonials of appreciative students prompted Khan to quit his job in finance as a hedge fund analyst at Connective Capital Management in 2009 and focus on the tutorials (then released under the moniker 'Khan Academy') full-time. From basic addition and subtraction

to highly complicated algebra and calculus, Khan Academy tutors its users on topics that include a wide array of topics in science, economics, finance and humanities. It even has test prep help. Khan is one of the fore-runners in the coming overhaul of the global education system.

SNAPCHAT

Formerly called 'Picaboo', the company now valued at \$800 million gave everyone a hard time getting their minds out of the gutter during its infant days. It's absurd that an app that simplifies sending lewd, profane or even innocent photos only to self destruct after a few seconds could be such a huge hit. Snapchat was launched in 2011 by two Stanford grads – Evan Spiegel and Bobby Murphy. It allows users to send images and texts privately, away from prying eyes. Looks like pictures speak louder than words. Originally, the idea was to create a website that required users to upload

"Ideas are like rabbits. You get a couple, learn how to handle them, and pretty soon you have a dozen."

– JOHN STEINBECK

photos and set a timer before sending them. Then an Aha! moment occurred and the duo decided to turn it into an app, since phones already have a camera.

THE BRIGHTEN APP

In 2013, while studying abroad in South Africa's Bucknell University, junior Austin Kevitch was devastated when a friend tragically died in a rock climbing accident. He was heartened, however, by the wonderful comments being posted on his friend's Facebook page. The comments inspired him and another friend to create a "compliment box" at their campus house, into which people could write and submit anonymous positive messages on sticky notes to roommates and friends. Reading the notes became such a daily highlight that Kevitch decided to spread the good vibes beyond his circle of friends. His Brighten app lets users anonymously post uplifting messages and words of encouragement to people they know. Its simple mission was "to make the world a happier place by improving the way people interact and view one another." 